Gabriel / Chosen

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CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 3 — GABRIEL / CHOSEN

CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 2

Joseph has just exited.

JOSEPH
Tomorrow?

MARY
Tomorrow.

Joseph disappears.

Mary remains alone.

For several seconds, nothing happens.

Let the audience stay with her happiness.

Mary looks toward the place Joseph exited.

She smiles.

She begins quietly putting things in order.

Perhaps she

folds a piece of cloth;

straightens the unfinished table piece Joseph showed her;

moves one of the chairs;

touches the wood and imagines the future they were just discussing.

She catches herself smiling.

MARY
Eight chairs.

She shakes her head.

MARY
Joseph...

Small laugh.

She resumes folding.

THE INTERRUPTION

The distant sounds of Nazareth are still present.

A voice.

A cart.

A child somewhere outside.

A faint hammer.

Then—

everything stops.

Not slowly.

Gone.

Mary notices.

She waits.

MARY
Hello?

Nothing.

She listens.

MARY
Is someone there?

A subtle musical texture enters.

Something completely different from the musical language of Nazareth.

Not loud.

Not threatening.

Unfamiliar.

The light begins changing.

Mary turns.

She sees GABRIEL.

Gabriel does not rush toward her.

Stillness is part of the power of the moment.

GABRIEL
Mary.

Mary steps backward.

MARY
Who are you?

GABRIEL
Do not be afraid.

MARY
I wasn't—

She stops.

MARY
I… ok, wait…

Mary stops and backs away

Gabriel remains calm.

GABRIEL
You have found favor with God.

Gabriel walks towards Mary

MARY
Favor?

Still walks away from Gabriel slowly

GABRIEL
Yes.

Continues walking towards Mary

MARY
I don't understand.

Still walks backwards away from Gabriel

GABRIEL
You will.

Continues walking towards Mary

Beat.

MARY
Who are you?

Still walks backwards away from Gabriel

GABRIEL
Gabriel.

A beat.

Stops walking and stands still

GABRIEL
I have been sent by God.

Mary stops, she absorbs that.

She looks toward the doorway, as though part of her still expects someone else to walk in and make this ordinary again.

No one does.

THE CALLING

GABRIEL
Mary...

you have been chosen.

Mary looks at him.

MARY
Chosen for what?

GABRIEL
You will bear a son.

Silence.

Mary does not respond.

MARY
I'm sorry—

what did you say?

GABRIEL
You will bear a son.

MARY
No.

Not rejection.

Her mind simply cannot make the words fit.

MARY
I mean—

how?

Beat.

MARY
How can that be?

GABRIEL
What will happen comes from God.

MARY
I understand the words.

Beat.

MARY
I don't understand how they can be true.

GABRIEL
Nothing God has spoken is beyond His power.

Mary looks at him carefully.

MARY
Why me?

GABRIEL
Because God has chosen you.

MARY
That doesn't answer the question.

Gabriel regards her.

Not offended.

GABRIEL
It may be the only answer you are given tonight.

That lands.

MARY SEARCHES FOR CERTAINTY

MARY
You expect me to believe this?

GABRIEL
I expect you to decide whether you will trust the One who sent me.

MARY
Those aren't the same thing.

GABRIEL
No.

They are not.

Mary studies him.

That answer surprises her.

MARY
What happens now?

GABRIEL
You live the answer.

MARY
That's all?

GABRIEL
No.

Beat.

GABRIEL
Your relative Elizabeth is also expecting a child.

Mary looks up.

MARY
Elizabeth?

GABRIEL
Yes.

MARY
But she—

Mary stops herself.

She knows what she was going to say.

GABRIEL
What seemed impossible...

is already happening.

Mary takes that in.

This is the first piece of the message she can attach to something in her world.

MARY
Elizabeth.

GABRIEL
Go to her if you need to see what God has already begun.

THE COST ARRIVES

Mary looks toward the unfinished table.

The future from Scene 2 is sitting in front of her.

The house.

The table.

The marriage.

Joseph.

Her breathing changes slightly.

MARY
What will people think?

Gabriel does not answer immediately.

MARY
My family?

The village?

Still no false reassurance.

MARY
Joseph...

That name lands hardest.

MARY
What am I supposed to tell Joseph?

GABRIEL
The truth.

MARY
And if the truth sounds impossible?

GABRIEL
It will still be the truth.

MARY
That doesn't mean he'll believe me.

GABRIEL
No.

Mary looks at Gabriel.

That is not the answer she wanted.

MARY
You don't know Joseph.

GABRIEL
God does.

MARY
He has plans.

Her eyes move back to the table.

MARY
We have plans.

A home.

A wedding.

A family.

Beat.

MARY

He thinks he knows how our life is supposed to go.

GABRIEL

And you?

Mary looks at him.

MARY

Until a moment ago...

so did I.

MUSICAL TRIGGER — “CHOSEN”

The first musical phrase begins.

Not triumph.

Not celebration.

A question.

Gabriel does not suddenly disappear.

He remains present, but the focus begins transferring to Mary.

The song begins because she has finally understood

This miracle has a cost.

“CHOSEN”

[VERSE 1]

I knew the road to the well,

I knew the shape of the day,

I knew the life I was promised

Would not be taken away.

BLOCKING: Mary stays where the dialogue leaves her, near the unfinished table. Do not move into a new “song position.”

I knew the voice of my mother,

I knew the work of my hands,

I knew the quiet kind of future

A girl like me could plan.

BLOCKING: On “the future,” touch or straighten the unfinished table. Let it represent the home, marriage, and life Mary expected. Gabriel stays grounded and mostly still.

Then the air begins to tremble,

Then the light begins to rise,

And a messenger of heaven

Is standing before my eyes.

BLOCKING: Mary looks back to Gabriel. The room she knows now feels unfamiliar. Gabriel does not chase or circle her.

[PRE-CHORUS 1]

And I want to run,

I want to hide,

BLOCKING: Mary takes one instinctive step toward the exit or away from Gabriel, then stops herself.

But somehow Your voice

Is already inside.

BLOCKING: Mary turns back toward Gabriel. Keep the movement simple.

[CHORUS 1]

Chosen,

Not ready, not strong,

I don’t know where this road will lead,

But I hear You calling.

BLOCKING: Mary moves only slightly downstage into open space. She is testing the word “chosen,” not celebrating it.

Chosen,

Can that be my name?

Can heaven ask these hands of mine

To hold what I can’t name?

BLOCKING: On “these hands of mine,” one brief look at her hands is enough.

I am afraid,

But I am listening.

Could I be chosen?

BLOCKING: Stop moving. Let the question hang.

[VERSE 2]

What will Joseph see

When he looks into my eyes?

Will he hear the truth in me,

Or only hear the lies?

BLOCKING: Mary moves toward the place Joseph exited, but does not leave.

What will the village say

When the whispers start to grow?

How do I carry heaven

When no one else can know?

BLOCKING: Become aware of the village outside the room. Do not mime people gossiping.

I thought faith was something steady,

Like a lamp beside the door.

Now it feels like stepping forward

Where there is no floor.

BLOCKING: Mary shifts her weight forward and begins the idea of a step, but stops before fully taking it. She wants to move, but fear still holds her.

[PRE-CHORUS 2]

How can this be?

How can this be?

I am small,

But still You see me.

BLOCKING: Stay grounded. Let the questions work on Mary instead of adding more movement.

[CHORUS 2]

Chosen,

Not ready, not strong,

I don’t know what this yes will cost,

But I hear You calling.

BLOCKING: On “what this yes will cost,” look back at the unfinished table, but do not return to it.

Chosen,

Is this why You came?

Can mercy ask a life like mine

To never be the same?

I am afraid,

But I am still listening.

Could I be chosen?

BLOCKING: Mary is still frightened, but she no longer retreats.

[BRIDGE]

I give You the wedding.

I give You the name.

I give You the future

I had already claimed.

BLOCKING: Mary returns to the unfinished table. Place the cloth or simple object she has been holding onto the table.

I give You the questions.

I give You the cost.

I give You the life

I thought was my own.

BLOCKING: Remove her hand from the table. This is a quiet release, not a dramatic gesture.

If faith is one step

Before the road is shown,

Then I will take it trembling,

But I will not walk alone.

BLOCKING: Mary now completes the step she could not take earlier. One deliberate step forward. She still cannot see the road, but now she chooses to move.

[FINAL CHORUS]

Chosen,

Not because I understand.

Chosen,

Not because I know the plan.

BLOCKING: Mary becomes steady, not triumphant. Use very little movement.

But if You are the One who calls me,

I will trust the One who knows.

Let the world misunderstand me,

Still my answer will be Yours.

BLOCKING: On “Let the world misunderstand me,” briefly acknowledge the village outside. On “Still my answer will be Yours,” return focus to Gabriel.

I am afraid,

But I am willing.

I am Yours.

I am chosen.

BLOCKING: Hold still on “But I am willing.” This is the emotional peak. No heroic pose or giant finish.

[TAG]

Let it be as You have spoken.

I am Yours.

I am chosen.

BLOCKING: Let the music settle. No victory pose. In the song, Mary makes the decision privately within herself. The spoken acceptance that follows is when she gives that decision to Gabriel — her final “yes.”

THE MUSIC APPROACHES ITS FINAL RESOLUTION

Mary turns toward Gabriel.

The music holds.

Then—

nearly stops.

Silence.

Mary breathes.

She is still afraid.

That matters.

MARY
I don't understand what comes next.

GABRIEL
I know.

MARY
And I'm afraid.

GABRIEL
I know.

Beat.

MARY
But if God has asked this of me...

She gathers herself.

MARY
I am the Lord's servant.

Beat.

MARY
Let it be with me as He has said.

Silence.

No instant explosion of music.

No triumphant celebration.

Let the decision stand by itself.

Gabriel regards her.

For the first time, there may be something almost tender in his expression.

GABRIEL
Do not be afraid, Mary.

Mary takes a breath.

MARY
I'm trying.

GABRIEL
That is enough for tonight.

GABRIEL DEPARTS

The light around Gabriel begins to change.

Do not make his departure a magic trick simply for spectacle.

It can be

a controlled fade;

a shift in light;

Gabriel moving into darkness;

Mary's attention being pulled briefly elsewhere and finding him gone.

The divine musical texture recedes.

Mary is alone again.

Same room.

Same wood.

Same cloth.

Same unfinished table.

Nothing looks different.

Everything is different.

FINAL MOMENT

Mary stands quietly.

She touches the unfinished table.

A faint fragment of “My Beloved” is heard.

Perhaps only a few notes.

Mary remembers

> *“Whatever comes, I'll walk with you.”*

Her expression changes.

Not because she regrets saying yes.

Because now she understands what she has to do next.

She looks toward the direction Joseph left.

MARY

Joseph...

NEAR-BLACK TRANSITION INTO SCENE 4: Hold a narrow special on Mary after “Joseph...” for one breath. Fade the surrounding stage and LED to deep blue near-black. Keep Mary's side exit path safely lit as she leaves. The unfinished table stays in place; the friends' small work props are preset. No furniture moves in darkness. Bring up ordinary daylight on the friends' work area.

END SCENE 3